

**NGC 2017**

A tight group of colorful stars in a chance alignment. Five have magnitudes between 6 and 10 and are visible with binoculars

Nihal (β Leporis)

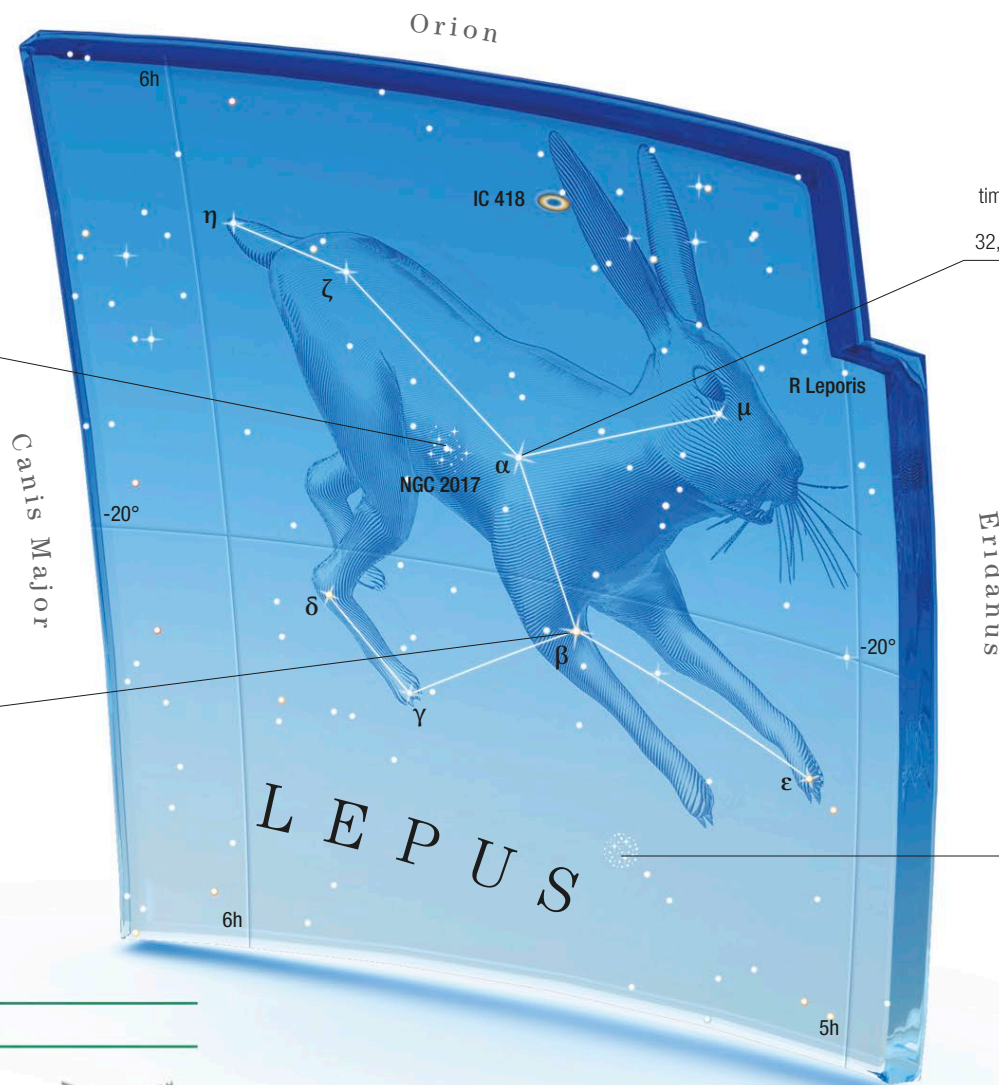
More than 10 times nearer to us than Alpha Leporis but at magnitude 2.8 not quite as bright. It is about 3.5 times the Sun's mass and 16 times its width

Arneb (α Leporis)

Lepus's brightest star at magnitude 2.6. It is 14 times the mass of the Sun, 129 times its size, and 32,000 times its luminosity

M79

More than 11 billion years old and 41,000 light-years away, this dim globular cluster consists of 150,000 stars, mostly red giants

**KEY DATA**

Size ranking 51

Brightest stars Arneb (α)
2.6, Nihal (β) 2.8

Genitive Leporis

Abbreviation Lep

Highest in sky at 10pm
January

Fully visible 62°N–90°S



CHART 6

MAIN STARS

Arneb Alpha (α) Leporis
White supergiant

☼ 2.6 ↔ 2,130 light-years

Nihal Beta (β) Leporis
Yellow giant

☼ 2.8 ↔ 160 light-years

Epsilon (ϵ) Leporis
Orange giant

☼ 3.2 ↔ 213 light-years

DEEP-SKY OBJECTS**M79**

Global cluster, also known as NGC 1904

NGC 2017

Multiple star

IC 418 (Spirograph Nebula)
Planetary nebula

LEPUS

THE HARE

LEPUS IS FOUND AS A BOW TIE SHAPE IMMEDIATELY TO THE SOUTH OF THE EASILY LOCATED CONSTELLATION ORION. ITS STARS, INCLUDING VARIABLES AND MULTIPLES, ARE ITS DISTINCTIVE FEATURE.

Greek mythology relates that this hare was placed in the sky after hares overwhelmed the island of Leros, devastating the land and causing starvation. The constellation was a permanent reminder about the perils of farming too many hares. Lepus is found to the south of Orion, appearing as if in flight from Orion's two hunting dogs Canis Major and Canis Minor. Its brightest star Alpha Leporis, has the name Arneb which comes from the Arabic for "hare." It is one of the most luminous stars visible from Earth. However, because of its distance, it is of only average brightness, with magnitude 2.6. The star R Leporis is a pulsating red giant, a Mira variable changing between magnitude 5.5 and 12 over a 430-day cycle. It is also known as Hind's Crimson Star after English astronomer John Russell Hind who observed it in 1845.



Sculptor